Brightside Family Dental - Office Policy Manual

Front desk and team policies, 2026

This manual is for every team member at Brightside Family Dental. It explains how we schedule, how we handle payment and insurance, and what we tell patients. Ask the office manager, Dana Ruiz, when something is not covered here.

1. Office hours

Monday to Thursday 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.; Friday 8:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. Closed on weekends. The last new-patient appointment of the day starts at 3:30 p.m.

2. Scheduling

New-patient visits are booked for 90 minutes and include a full exam, X-rays and a cleaning when time allows. Routine hygiene visits are 60 minutes. Emergency slots are held at 11:00 a.m. and 2:00 p.m. each weekday.

Recall: adults are scheduled every 6 months; patients with periodontal disease every 3 months.

Patients under 18 must be accompanied by a parent or legal guardian at their first visit, and a guardian must sign the consent form.

3. Cancellations and missed appointments

We ask for 48 hours' notice to cancel or move an appointment. The first late cancellation or missed appointment in a 12-month period is waived. After that, a $50 fee is charged for each late cancellation or missed appointment.

After 3 missed appointments in 12 months, the patient may only book same-day appointments.

4. Payment

Copays and the patient's estimated portion are due at the visit. We accept cash, debit and credit cards, and health savings account cards. We do not accept personal checks.

For treatment plans over $600, patients may pay in equal monthly instalments over up to 6 months with no interest. The first instalment is due when treatment starts.

Patients without insurance receive 10% off when they pay in full at the visit.

5. Insurance

We are in network with Coastal Shield Dental PPO and SunState Basic Dental HMO. Benefits for those plans are in the plan summaries in this pack. For any other plan we file the claim as a courtesy, and the patient pays our full fee at the visit.

Always verify eligibility at least 2 business days before the appointment and note the remaining annual maximum in the chart.

6. X-rays

Bitewing X-rays are taken once a year for adults. A full-mouth series is taken every 5 years, or sooner when the dentist orders it. Pregnant patients are asked to tell us before any X-ray.

7. After-hours emergencies

Outside office hours, patients call the main number and press 2 to reach the dentist on call. Patients with facial swelling that affects breathing or swallowing are told to go to the emergency room.